

Troubleshoot Environment Variables

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Find suggested solutions for common errors while working with environment variables.

PUBLIC__ variable not available in client code.

Your client-side code can't access a variable that you prefixed with PUBLIC__.

Cause: A single underscore or missing prefix means the variable is treated as server-only.

Suggested Solution: Verify the variable name starts with PUBLIC__ (two underscores).

Config path error on startup.

Your app fails to start and displays a config path error.

Cause: The path in your PUBLIC__ variable name isn't found in config.server.ts.

Suggested Solution: The path in your PUBLIC__ variable name must exist in config.server.ts. Add the field and its default value to the config before setting the environment variable.

Environment Variable Isn't Set

Your code throws an `Error` stating that a variable is missing.

Cause: The environment variable that the code calls isn't set.



Incorrect Environment Variable Name

Your code logs an error message stating that the environment variable wasn't found.

Cause: The code couldn't find the environment variable because of a typo or incorrect variable name.

Suggested Solution: Confirm that you spelled the environment variable name correctly and that you're using the right name. To see all set variables, call the [projects_target_env_var_list](#) API endpoint.

Unsupported Environment Variable Name

Your API call to set an environment variable fails.

Cause: The environment variable name doesn't comply with the [constraints](#). For example, the variable value exceeds 32 KB.

Suggested Solution: Confirm that your environment variable complies with the [constraints](#).

Invalid API Key Format

Authentication errors occur when you execute code that uses an API key.

Cause: The API key that you used when you set the environment variable isn't in the expected format or is missing.

Suggested Solution: Confirm that the API key stored by an environment variable is correct. If needed, call the [projects_target_env_var_partial_update](#) API endpoint to correct the API key.

Invalid URL for an API Endpoint

A `fetch` request fails with a network error.

Cause: A URL for an API endpoint in your code is missing or invalid. For example,



correct.

Variable Has No Effect After Being Set

Cause: Environment variables load at startup. A running server doesn't pick up changes automatically.

Suggested Solution: Restart your dev server.

PUBLIC__ Variable Not Available in Client Code

Cause: A single underscore or missing prefix marks the variable as server-only.

Suggested Solution: Verify that the variable name starts with `PUBLIC__` (two underscores).

Config Path Error on Startup

Cause: The path in your `PUBLIC__` variable name isn't found in `config.server.ts`.

Suggested Solution: Add the path and its default value to `config.server.ts` before setting the environment variable.

Variable Value Is the Wrong Type

Cause: The variable value isn't formatted correctly for its type. The app parses values automatically.

Suggested Solution: For booleans, use the string `true` or `false`. For arrays and objects, use valid JSON. Confirm the value is formatted correctly in your `.env` file or in Runtime Admin.

API Call to Update Variables Fails

Cause: This error can be caused by insufficient permissions, an invalid API key, or a reserved prefix.

Suggested Solution: Confirm that you have the developer or admin role on the

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Variable Set in Runtime Admin Is Not Available After Deployment

Cause: You likely didn't deploy the bundle after setting the variable.

Suggested Solution: Make sure that you deployed your bundle after setting the variable. Existing running instances use the variables that were active at deploy time.

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